

Look Again: How We Check

The Garden Welcome Sign

GARDEN WELCOME SIGN



ABOUT THIS BOOK

Written by Maria Smith

Smithian Fold Theory Open Education Library
Book E04 - Review version 1.0.0

Copyright 2026 Maria Smith
Licensed CC BY 4.0

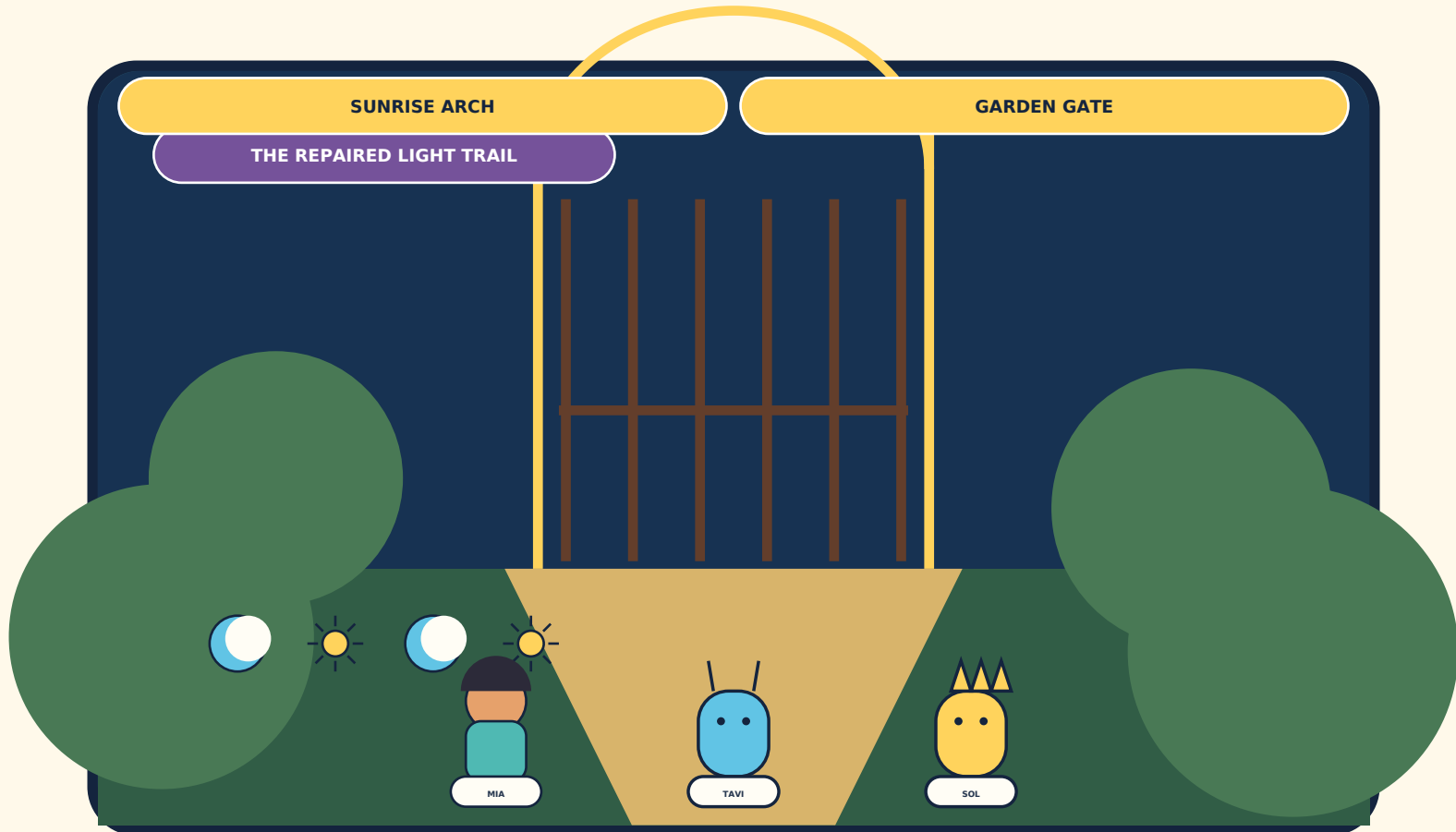
A live review edition. It is not an approved final publication.



Last time, Mia, Sol and Tavi repaired the turning-light trail. The light reached the Sunrise Arch.

At the garden gate, Tavi asked, "How can we check our work?"

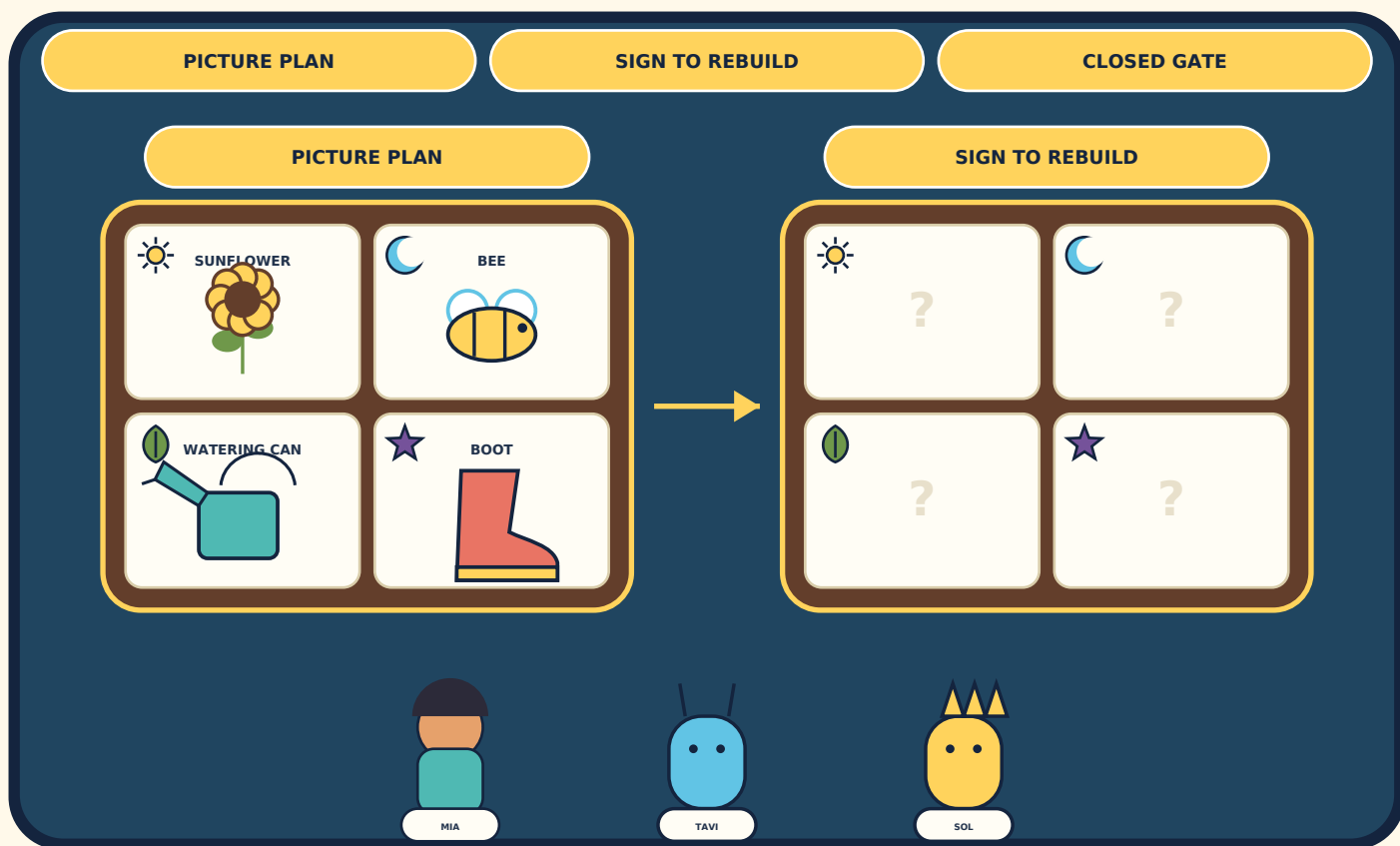
Now the friends will learn how looking again can help them answer that question.



A board beside the gate showed four empty spaces. A card above it showed the pictures that belonged there.

The gate would open only after the friends rebuilt the Garden Welcome Sign and checked it carefully.

Your mission: rebuild and check the sign before the morning visitors arrive.

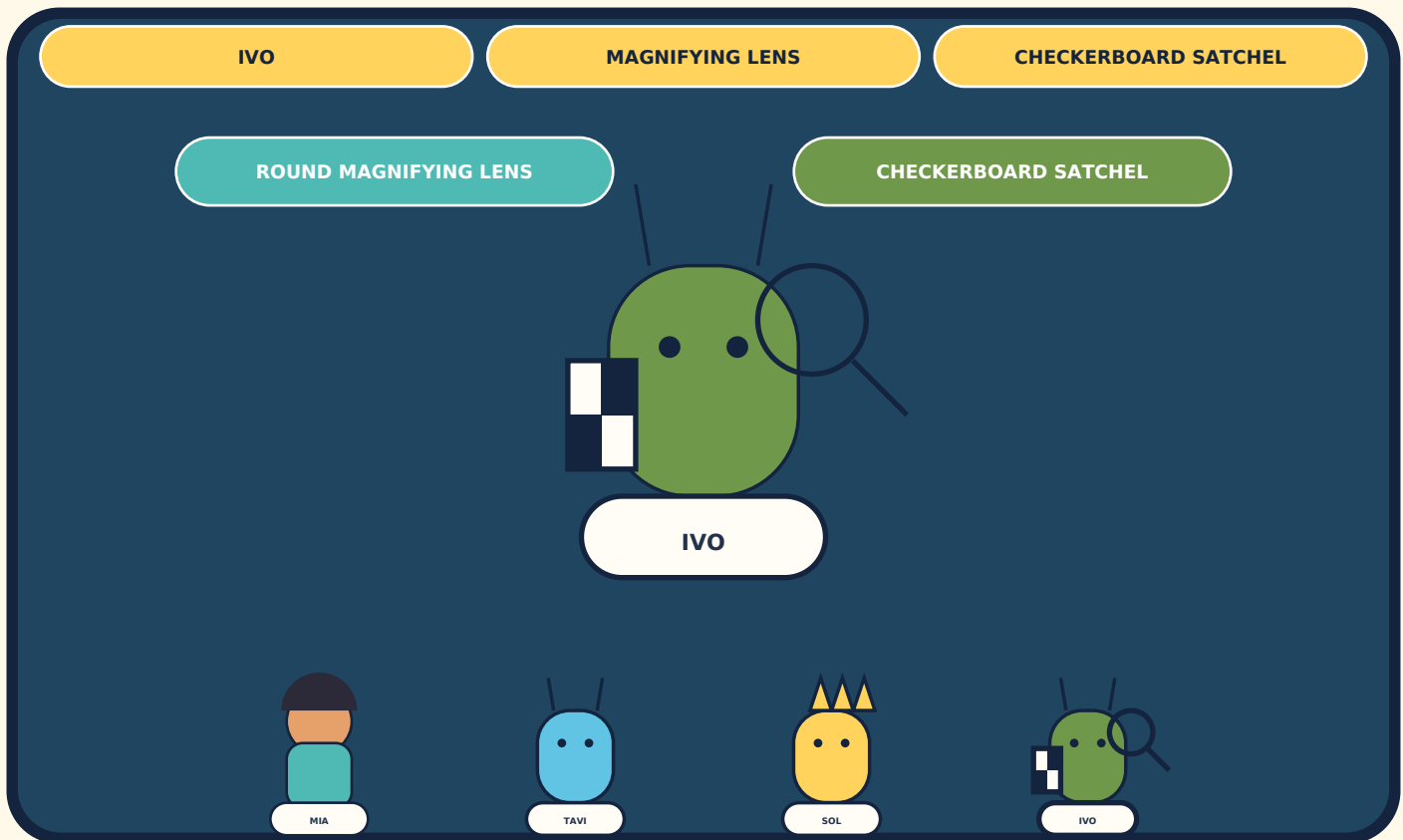


MEET IVO

A small moss-green friend hurried out from the garden. He carried a round magnifying lens and a checkerboard satchel.

"Hello! I am Ivo, the garden checker. I can help you look again, but I will not choose your answers for you."

Ivo is the one new friend on this adventure. The same four friends will solve one sign problem together.



Ivo stood the picture plan where everyone could see it. Each space had a corner mark and one clear picture.

"First, let us say what we can see," said Mia.

When you look at something that is shown and tell what you see, you make an observation. A guess is an answer chosen without checking what is shown.



Look at the shown picture plan.

Which picture is in the MOON corner? Point to it before you turn the page.

Use the picture that is really there. You do not need to guess.

SHOWN SOURCE PLAN

 SUNFLOWER 	 BEE 
 WATERING CAN 	 BOOT 

SUNFLOWER


BEE


WATERING CAN


BOOT


The BEE is in the MOON corner. We know because we looked at the shown plan.

An OBSERVATION tells what we can see. A GUESS chooses without that check.

Looking first gives the team a clear starting record. Find the optional picture code.



2 - BUILD THE BOARD

Ivo opened his satchel. Inside were four large picture cards and one blank wooden sign.

The source plan stayed upright. The friends could look from the plan to the blank sign as often as they needed.

The team will build from the shown source instead of choosing a favourite arrangement.

SOURCE PLAN

BLANK SIGN

FOUR PICTURE CARDS

SOURCE

BLANK SIGN

SUNFLOWER

BEE

WATERING CAN

BOOT

SUNFLOWER

BEE

WATERING CAN

BOOT

Point to each card, then point to its matching marked corner on the blank sign.

Use every card once. Leave no space empty.

Check the source plan after every picture you place.

SOURCE

  SUNFLOWER	  BEE
 WATERING CAN	  BOOT

BLANK SIGN

 ?	 ?
 ?	 ?

SUNFLOWER



BEE



WATERING CAN



BOOT



THE FIRST SIGN IS BUILT

SUNFLOWER is in the **SUN** corner. **BEE** is in the **MOON** corner.
WATERING CAN is in the **LEAF** corner. **BOOT** is in the **STAR** corner.

All four source pictures are on the sign, in the shown places.

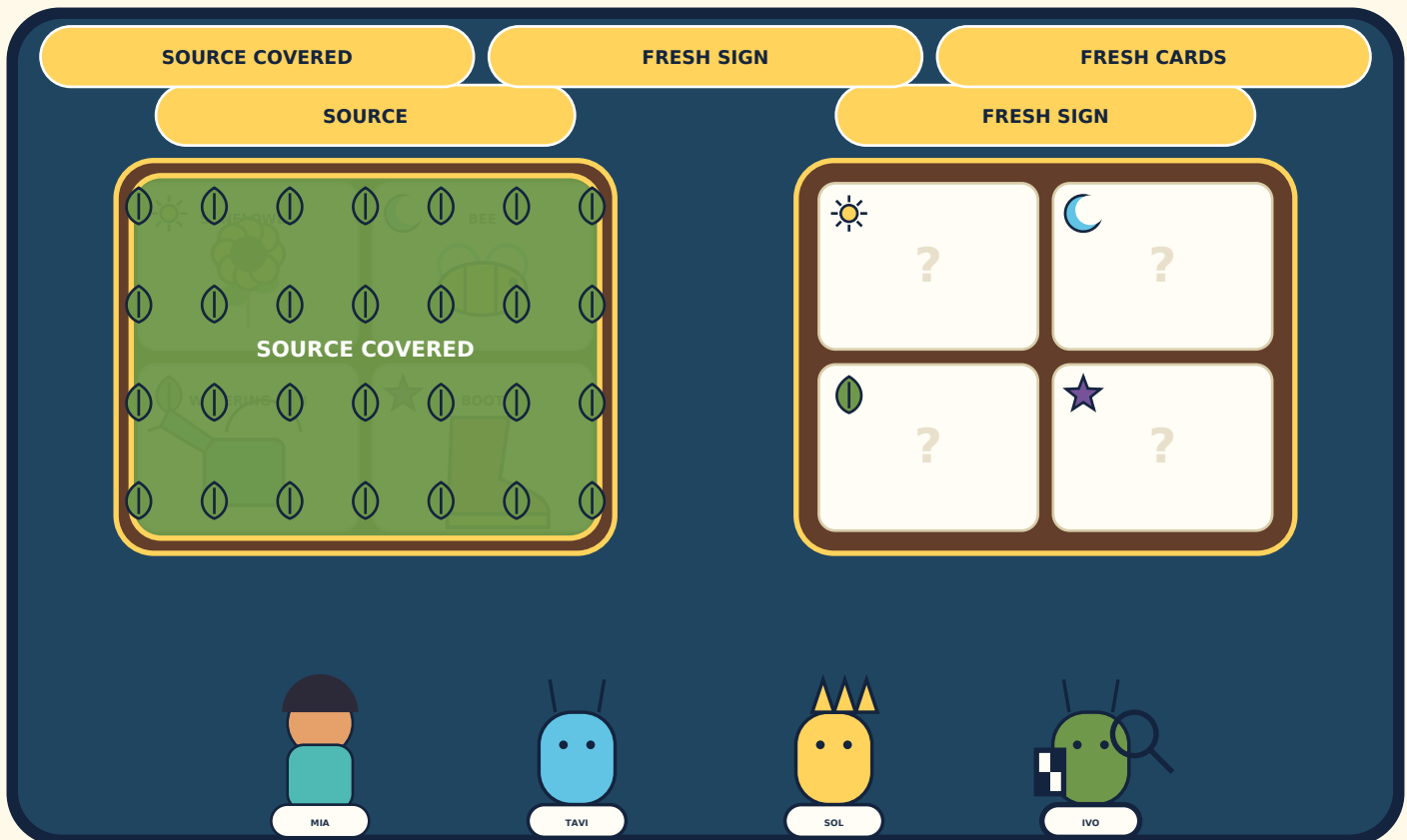
The team built one complete sign while the source was visible. Find the optional picture code.



Ivo covered the source plan and the first sign with a leafy curtain. He put out a fresh blank sign and four fresh picture cards.

"Now we can try to rebuild what we remember," said Tavi.

The covered sign has not vanished. It is still behind the curtain, ready for a later check.



Sol made this memory rebuild:

SUNFLOWER at SUN. BOOT at MOON. WATERING CAN at LEAF. BEE at STAR.

Does it match the covered source? Say MATCH or NOT SURE before the curtain opens.

It is honest to say NOT SURE when the source is covered. The next page will let us check.

SOURCE

SOURCE COVERED

SOL'S MEMORY REBUILD

 SUNFLOWER 	 BOOT
 WATERING CAN	 BEE

MATCH

NOT SURE

KEEP THE FIRST REBUILD

Ivo opened the curtain. The memory rebuild did NOT match the source. BEE and BOOT had traded places.

The friends did not hide Sol's try. They moved it onto a stand marked FIRST REBUILD.

A failed attempt can help us check what changed. Find the optional picture code.

SOURCE

FIRST REBUILD - KEEP

BEE

BOOT

SOURCE

FIRST REBUILD - KEEP

SUNFLOWER

WATERING CAN

BEE

BOOT

SUNFLOWER

WATERING CAN

BOOT

BEE

MIA

TAVI

SOL

IVO

KEEPFIRST

Look from the SOURCE sign to the FIRST REBUILD. Check one marked corner at a time.

Which two pictures are in different places?

Point to the changed pictures on the first rebuild before you turn the page.

SOURCE

 SUNFLOWER	 BEE
 WATERING CAN	 BOOT

FIRST REBUILD - KEEP

 SUNFLOWER	 BOOT
 WATERING CAN	 BEE

POINT TO EVERY DIFFERENCE


MIA


TAVI


SOL


IVO

BEE and BOOT are the two differences. SUNFLOWER and WATERING CAN stayed in their source places.

The friends compared every corner. They did not guess from one quick look.

COMPARE means look at two records together to find what is the same and what is different.
Find the optional picture code.

DIFFERENCE: BEE

DIFFERENCE: BOOT

SAME

SAME

SOURCE

FIRST REBUILD - KEEP

SUNFLOWER

WATERING CAN

BEE

BOOT

SUNFLOWER

WATERING CAN

BOOT

BEE

MIA

TAVI

SOL

IVO

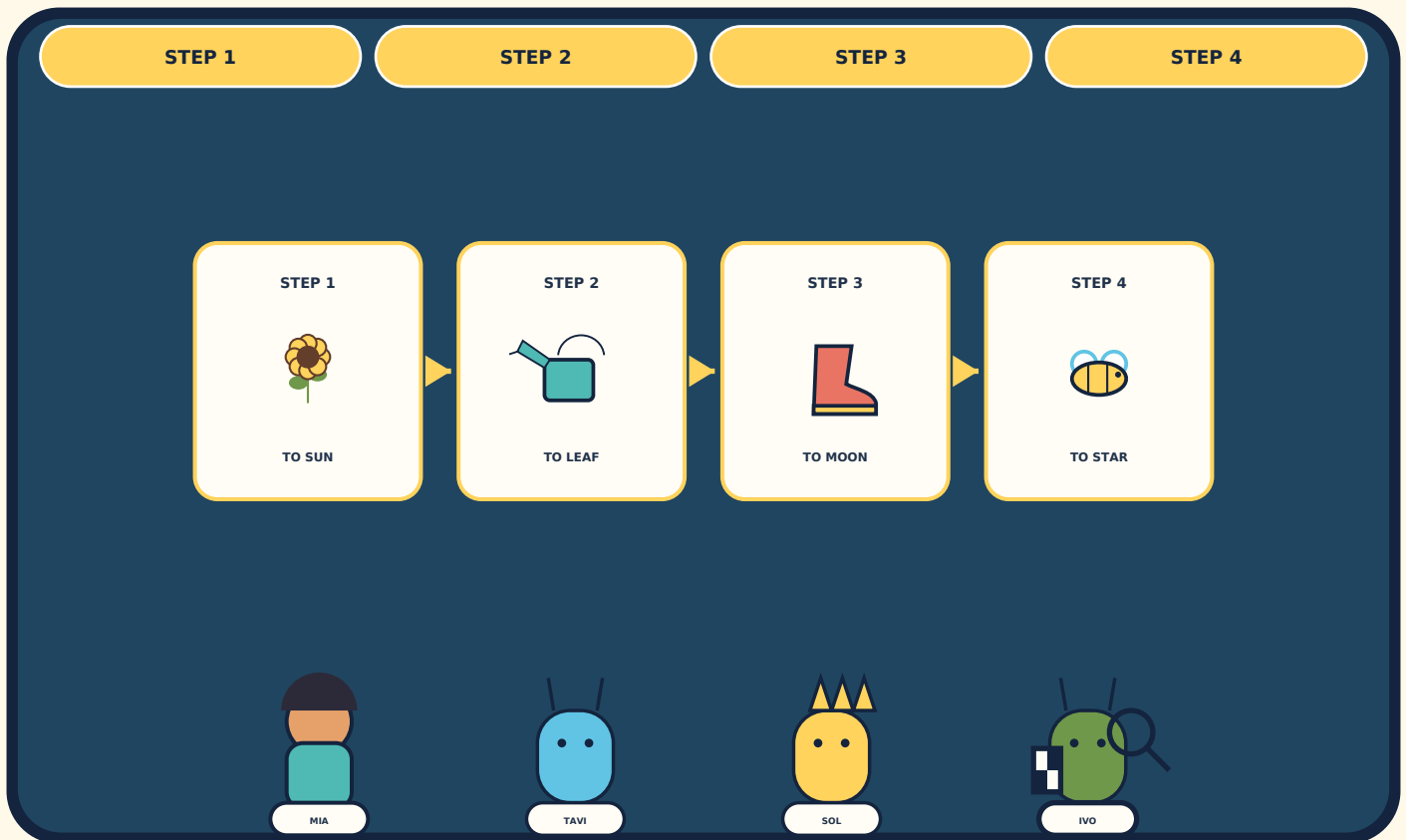
SPOTCHANGE

5 - FOLLOW THE STEP TRACE

Ivo had clipped one step card to a string after every picture Sol placed. The cards kept the order of his work.

"This step trace can show us what happened first, next and last," said Ivo.

A TRACE is a kept record of the steps in the order they happened.



Start at STEP 1. Compare each step card with the source plan.

Which is the first step that does not follow the source?

Follow the record in order. Keep every step visible.



STEP 1

STEP 2

STEP 3

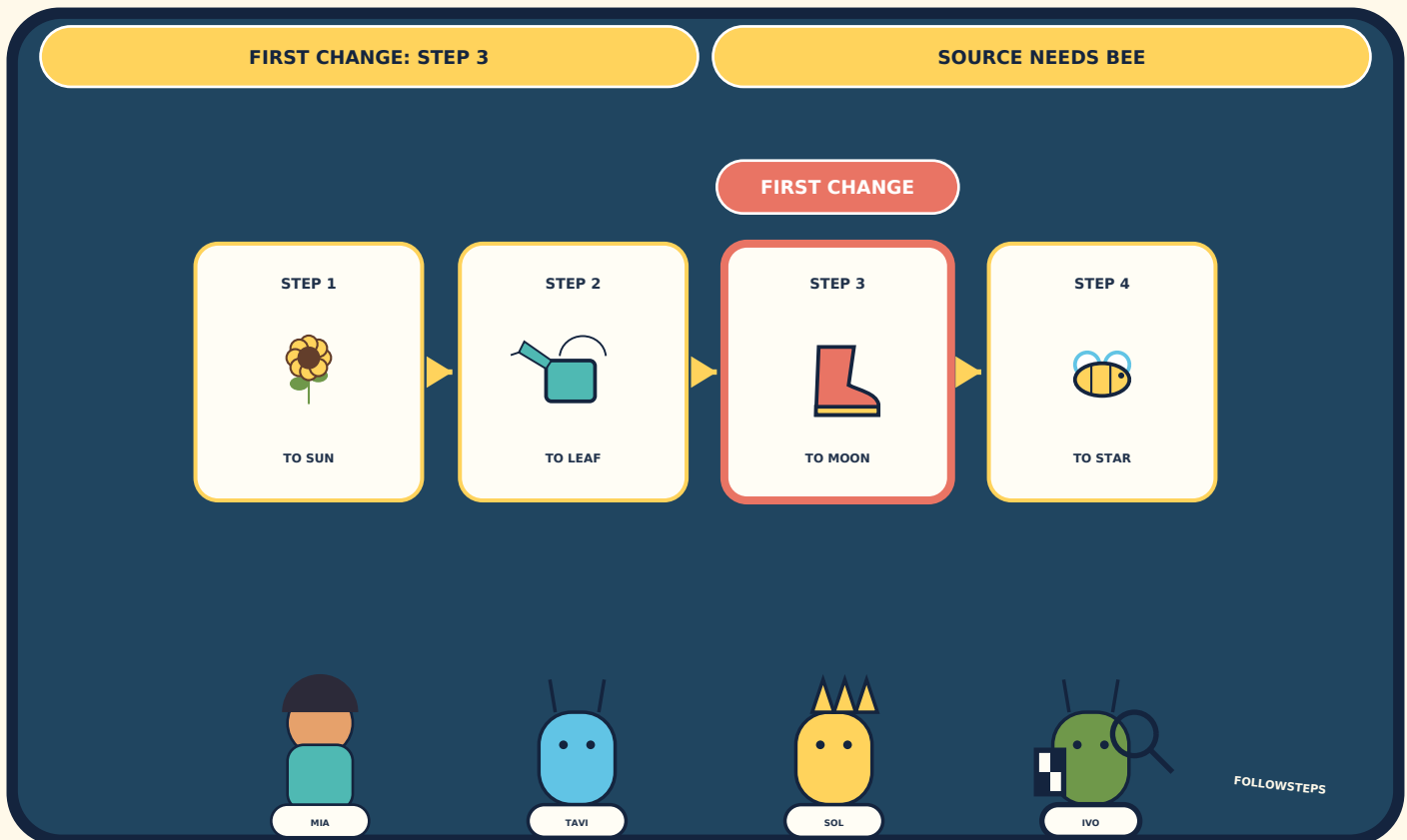
STEP 4

STEP 3 IS THE FIRST CHANGE

STEP 3 put **BOOT** in the **MOON** corner. The source needed **BEE** there. **STEP 4** then put **BEE** in the only space left.

The trace showed where the swap began.

Keeping the ordered steps helps the team repair the cause, not just notice the final difference.
Find the optional picture code.



The friends repaired the two changed places. The pictures now matched the source, but the wooden sign still had to fit between two gate hooks.

Ivo chose a ribbon labelled **WIDTH**. "This tool answers one question: Is the sign narrow enough to fit between the hooks?"

WIDTH means the distance from one side to the other side. The ribbon is not checking the pictures or the height.



TRY IT - CHECK THE WIDTH

The sign's two side edges reach the two green marks on the WIDTH ribbon. The marks show the space between the hooks.

Does this width fit? Point to FITS or TOO WIDE.

Answer only the width question that the tool was chosen to check.



THE WIDTH FITS

The WIDTH fits between the hooks. The two side edges meet the two green marks.

The ribbon answered its width question. It did NOT tell us whether the pictures match or whether the height fits.

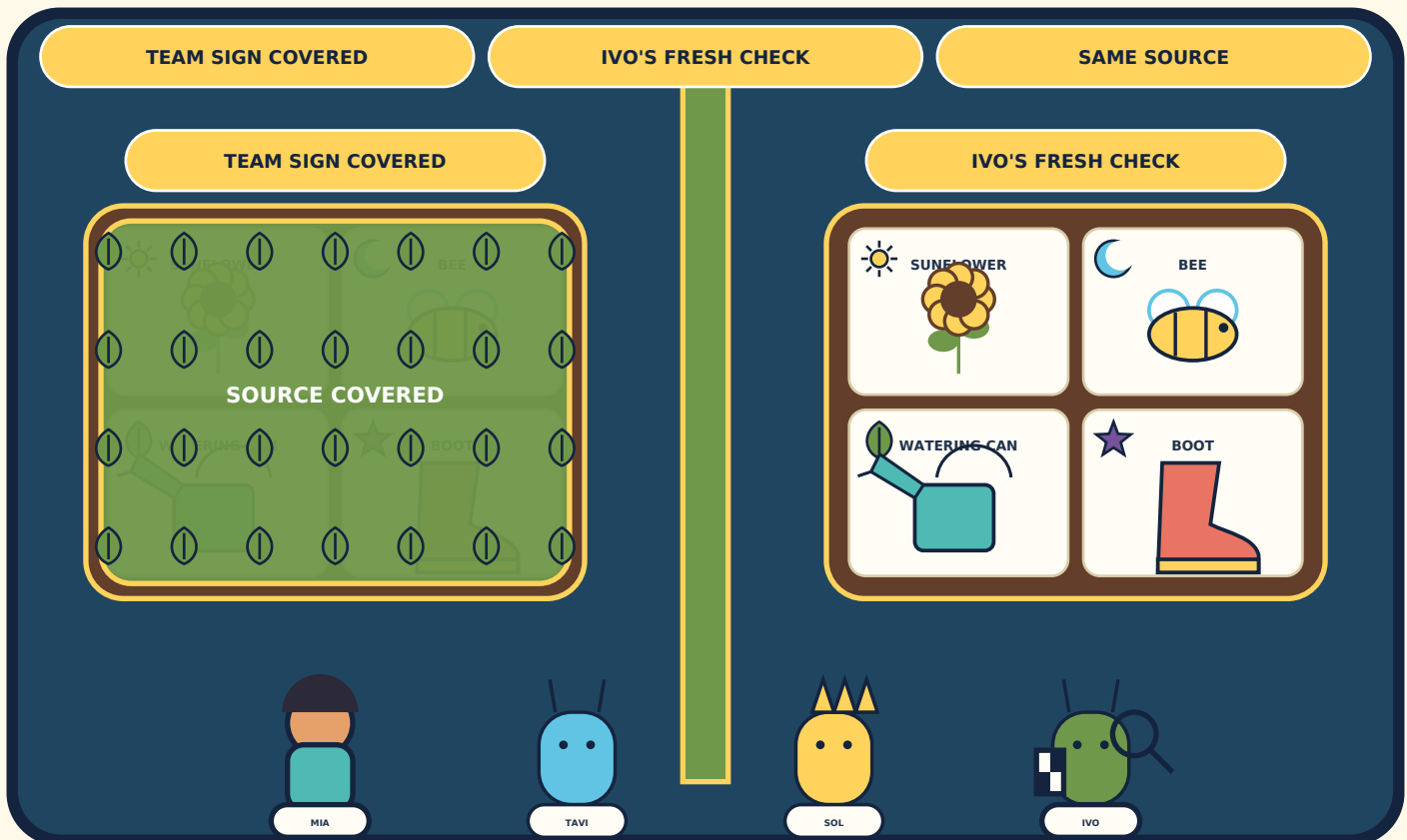
A measuring tool answers only the question we chose and declared. Find the optional picture code.



The trio turned their repaired sign away. Ivo took a fresh blank board, fresh picture cards and the original source plan behind the hedge.

He rebuilt the sign without seeing their answer.

An INDEPENDENT CHECK uses its own clear path instead of copying the first answer.



**Now uncover the TEAM SIGN and IVO'S CHECK.
Compare one marked corner at a time.**

**Do all four picture places match? Point to CONFIRM
or DISAGREE.**

Confirm means the independent check agrees. Disagree means the two results do not match.

TEAM SIGN	IVO'S CHECK
 SUNFLOWER  BEE	 SUNFLOWER  BEE
 WATERING CAN  BOOT	 WATERING CAN  BOOT
CONFIRM	DISAGREE

IVO'S CHECK CONFIRMS THE PICTURES

**All four picture places match. Ivo's fresh check
CONFIRMS the team's repaired sign.**

**A friend check can confirm, disagree, or show that
more work is needed.**

This check confirms the picture places. It does not erase the failed first rebuild. Find the optional picture code.

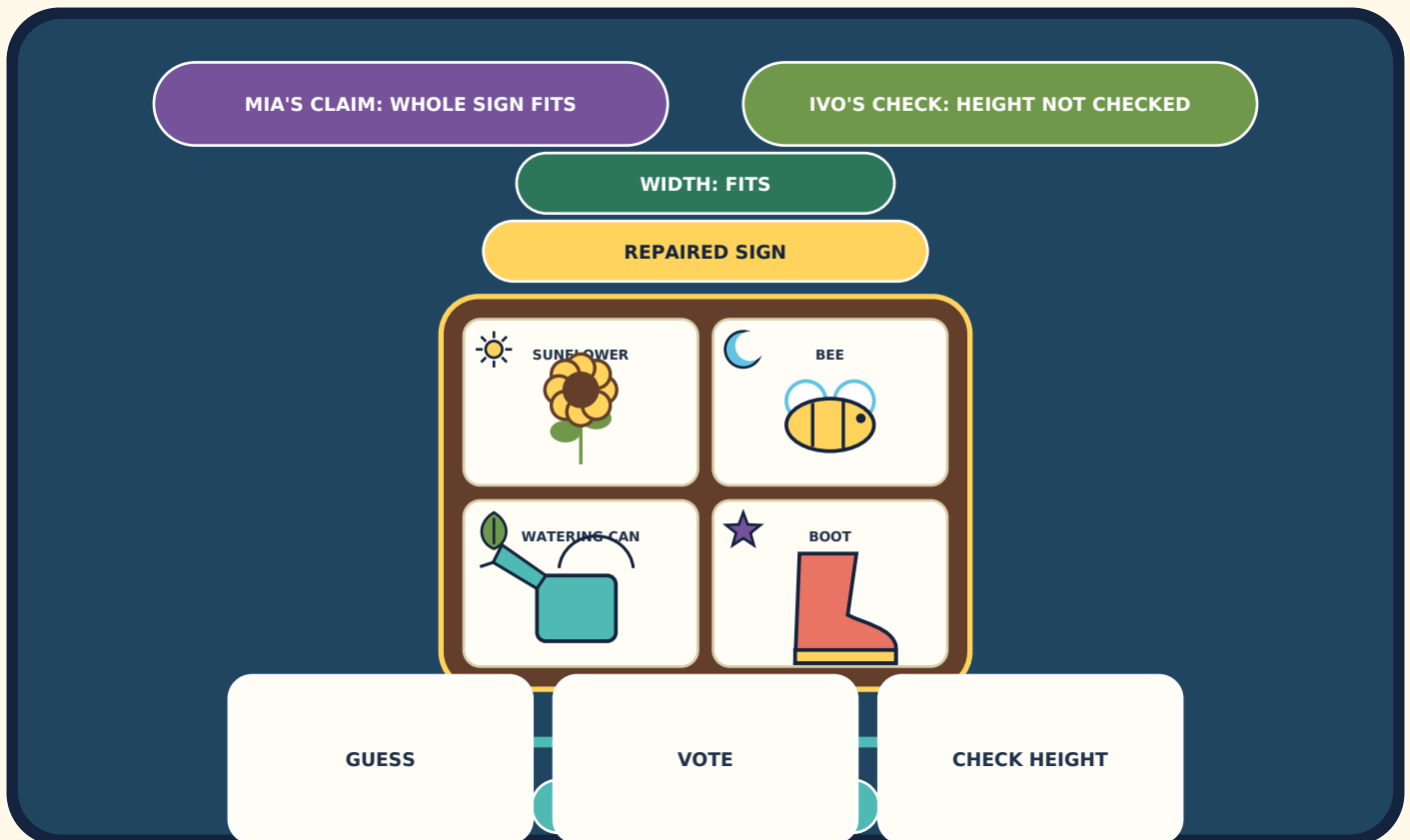


"The width fits, so the whole sign must fit," said Mia.

"I disagree," said Ivo. "The width ribbon did not check the height."

What should the team do next: guess, vote, or check the HEIGHT with a height tool?

A disagreement does not make the loudest person the answer. It can show that more work is needed.



THE DISAGREEMENT NEEDED MORE WORK

The team chose a **HEIGHT** ribbon and declared a new question: Is the sign short enough for the gate?

The top and bottom edges reached the green height marks. **HEIGHT** fits too.

Ivo did not prove Mia wrong by saying so. Their disagreement showed which question still needed checking. Find the optional picture code.

HEIGHT RIBBON

TOP EDGE

BOTTOM EDGE

HEIGHT: FITS

REPAIRED SIGN

SUNFLOWER

BEE

WATERING CAN

BOOT

HEIGHT

MORE WORK ANSWERED THE MISSING QUESTION

MIA

TAVI

SOL

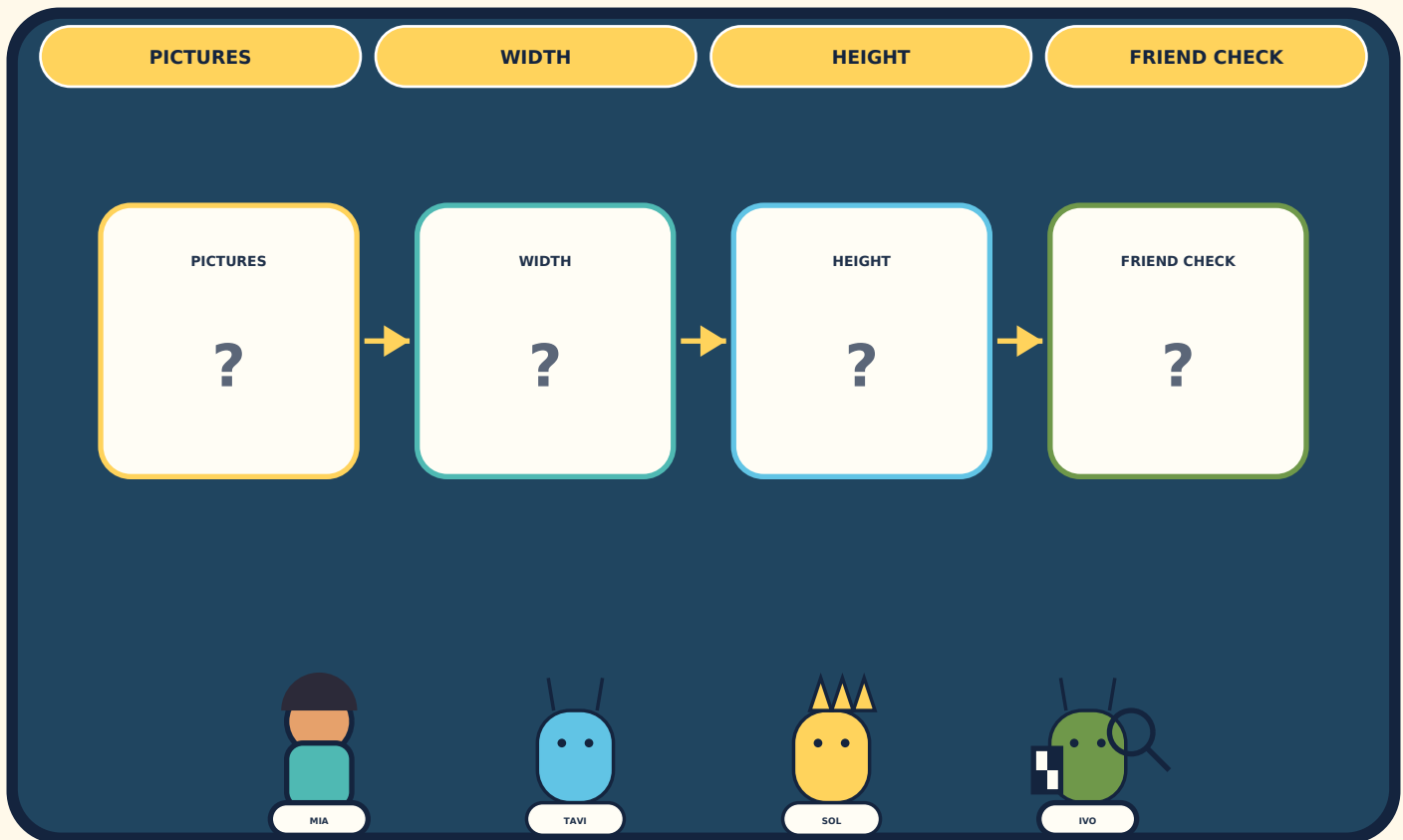
IVO

MOREWORK

Only the final checkpoint remained. The gate showed four questions:

Do the pictures match the source? Does the width fit? Does the height fit? Did a separate friend check agree?

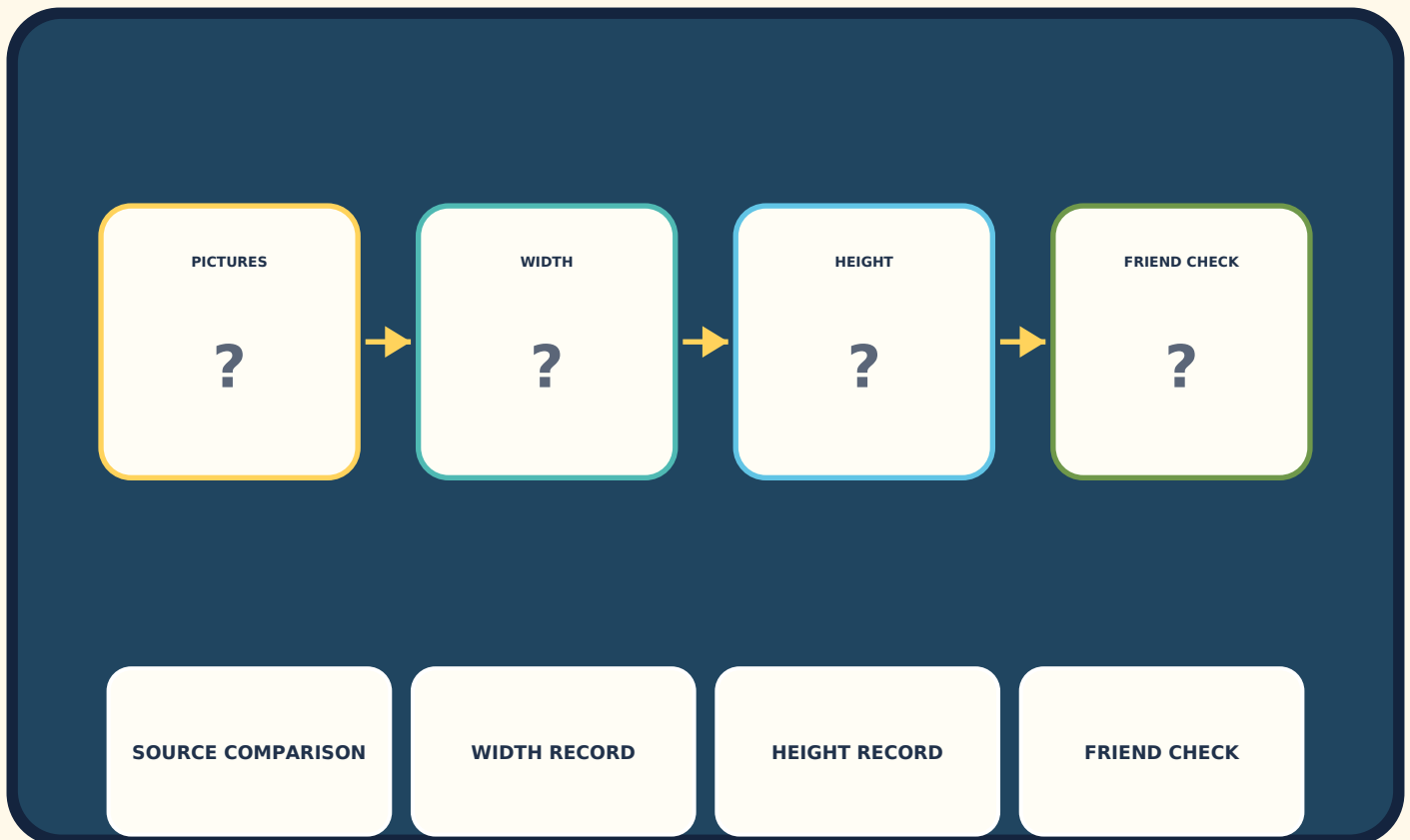
The gate will open only when every declared check has a visible record.



Match each gate question to the record that answers it.

Point to PICTURES, WIDTH, HEIGHT and FRIEND CHECK in turn. Can every question be supported?

Use the visible records. Do not add a tick just because the sign looks nice.



EVERY CHECK HAS A RECORD

PICTURES match the source. WIDTH fits. HEIGHT fits. IVO'S FRESH CHECK agrees.

**The checked rebuild passed every declared checkpoint.
The gate opened before the visitors arrived!**

The first failed rebuild and the width-only conclusion stay in the checking book. Find the optional picture code.



YOU LEARNED HOW TO CHECK

You looked at what was shown instead of guessing. You built the sign, covered it, rebuilt it, and kept the first try when it did not match. You followed the step trace, used each measuring tool for its own question, and asked Ivo to check by a fresh path.

A check can CONFIRM, DISAGREE, or show that MORE WORK is needed.

This matters because looking again helps us say what we observed, find what changed, and know which question still needs an answer.



THE GARDEN GATE OPENS

**The morning visitors followed the checked sign into the garden.
Mia, Sol, Tavi and Ivo watched each visitor find the right path.**

**At the far wall, another Star Door gave one soft click. The friends
smiled. They would discover where it led on their next learning
adventure.**

End of the Early Years checking adventure. The next book remains a new question until its own reviewed syllabus is opened.

